

**Board 1**

North Deals

None Vul

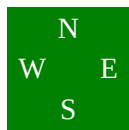
♠ 10 4 3  
♥ 10 8 5 2  
♦ K J 8 6  
♣ K 8

♠ A K Q J 5 2

♥ K Q 7

♦ 5 3

♣ 9 4



♠ 9 7

♥ A J 6 4

♦ Q 10

♣ Q J 10 5 2

♠ 8 6

♥ 9 3

♦ A 9 7 4 2

♣ A 7 6 3

| West     | North | East | South |
|----------|-------|------|-------|
|          | 1♠    | Pass | 1NT   |
| Pass     | 3♠    | Pass | 4♠    |
| All Pass |       |      |       |

4♠ by North

East will win and probably lead a trump. You win, cash the ♥K and ruff your small ♥ with dummy's last trump. Now take the ♦A and give up the lead. Ruff at the first opportunity and pull trumps, making 6 ♠ tricks, 2 minor suit Aces, one ♥ trick and a ♥ ruff in dummy.

It's easy to decide whether to draw trumps or not.

Always draw them - unless you have some other need for them first. Like in this hand.

Notice this. You cannot fault East for his opening lead, top of an honor sequence is very logical. **BUT**, if he had led a trump you would have gone down.

You have an easy choice, you open 1♠.

Partner responds 1NT.

Partner is showing 6-10 points. With 17 points you are strong enough to invite game. You show your 6-card suit by jumping to 3♠. Partner bids 4♠.

North plays 4♠. East leads the ♣Q.

**North plays 4♠. East leads the ♣Q.**

Losers: ♠ 0 : ♥ 2 : ♦ 1 : ♣ 1 : Total = 4

You have no time to waste. You have no way to discard either minor suit loser, so you absolutely must ruff a ♥ in dummy. You dare not pull a trump.

Win the ♣A in dummy and play a ♥ to your ♥Q.

**Board 3**

East Deals

E-W Vul

♠ 10 6 4

♥ A 5

♦ 9 6 4 3

♣ K J 6 2

♠ J 5

♥ 9 7

♦ K Q 10 8

♣ A Q 9 8 3



♠ A K Q 9 8

♥ K 8 3

♦ J 5 2

♣ 7 4

♠ 7 3 2

♥ Q J 10 6 4 2

♦ A 7

♣ 10 5

West

North

East

South

1 ♠

Pass

2 ♠

All Pass

2 ♠ by East

You open 1 ♠. Partner responds 2 ♠. What is your bid?

This was easy. You had a minimum opening bid and partner gave a minimum response. You pass.

East plays 2 ♠. South leads the ♥ Q.

**East plays 2 ♠. South leads the ♥ Q, North plays ♥ 9.**

Losers: ♠ 0 : ♥ 1 : ♦ 3 : ♣ 2 : Total = 6

You have one loser too many. It doesn't seem you can do anything about the 3 ♦ s but you might be able to avoid one of the ♣ s if you are lucky. However, you can probably get rid of the ♥ loser by ruffing it in dummy.

One small worry - North's play of the ♥ 9 might be the start of a doubleton signal. If so, he may be able to over-ruff dummy. You should have played the ♥ A on the first trick. Next you pull two rounds of trumps with ♠ A, ♠ K. Only then do you play ♥ K and ♥ 8 ruffing with dummy's last trump. Fortunately North only had two trumps and cannot over-ruff, even though he is out of ♥ s.

When you get back in you will pull trumps and lead toward dummy's ♣ K J, hoping to make a good guess.

As you see, the ♣ A Q were sitting badly and you could not win a ♣ trick.

The only way to make the contract was to ruff a ♥ in dummy.